

PRINCIPLES THAT LEAD TO SUCCESS

Blue denotes power point slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

TEXT: 1 Chronicles 12:18 (KJV) *"Then the spirit came upon Amasai, who was chief of the captains, and he said, Thine are we, David, and on thy side, thou son of Jesse: peace, peace be unto thee, and peace be to thine helpers; for thy God helpeth thee. Then David received them, and made them captains of the band."*

INTRO: If there were a predominant sin of the age that we live in, I would think it must be the sin of half-heartedness. There is a real deficiency of commitment to God or anything else for that matter. **In this culture many are no longer committed to: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Family...
- Marriage...
- Profession...
- Institutions...

(Story of the chicken, pig, and the mission's breakfast. The chicken only had to be involved; the pig had to be committed.)

I am convinced that it is the will of God for us to be committed to the purposes of God and to have victory in every situation! The Christian life should be a journey

"From faith to faith, and victory to victory."

If we are planning to be victorious we must make up our minds that no matter what happens, we will not give up, or be sidetracked!

In this chapter David is brought before us as a type of Christ. David was God's appointed and anointed king, but initially only a few accepted him as such. The majority gave their allegiance to Saul, whom God had rejected! They thought they were on the winning team, when in reality they were on a team doomed to failure. No matter how lopsided the odds may be in our favor or in opposition to us, if God is not in the mix, success will be an elusive commodity.

There are many people in this world who would give their right arm to control everything which affects their lives but I want to declare today that Jesus Christ is the rightful King; God has appointed and anointed him! **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)** [Philippians 2:9,10](#) (KJV) *"Wherefore God also hath highly exalted him and given him a name which is above every name: That at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, of things in heaven, and things in earth, and things under the earth;"* [Ephesians 1:20](#) (KJV) *".. God raised Jesus from the dead and set him at his own right hand in heavenly places..."* [Ephesians 2:6](#) (KJV) *"God has raised us up with Christ and has made us to sit together in heavenly places."*

In our text David had been rejected by the man he was sworn to serve, he is being hunted by a psychotic King, and living in primitive conditions with his men and their families in the wilderness. It is against this backdrop that the eleven men of the tribe of Gad make

a bold move in defecting from the military machine of Saul and commit to follow David. David could not have needed such men to follow him more than at this particular time. David was in dire need of people who not only admired him at a distance and believed in him secretly, but people who would come out boldly and follow him. As a pastor I have been there when people said *"All we need is someone to stand up ..."* When you do, you are often the only one who is! People will say *"We are behind you brother..."* They are so far behind you; they are only a faint speck in the rear view mirror! (Story of the guy on a bicycle who pulled up beside the corvette at the stoplight and was admiring such a sleek driving machine...)

Pastors and church leaders greatly appreciate those who will stand with them in difficult times! The reward of such people will be great in Heaven. [*The loyal support of Gods people for His leaders does not escape the attention of eternal reward.*](#)

David needed people who would not turn their backs on the day of battle! This is exactly what our King is looking for today, people with a made up mind who will stand boldly against the enemy and the tide of darkness, and be counted in the army of God!

Young people, whether you are going to be a business man or woman, a pastor, missionary, deacon, youth pastor, butler, baker, candlestick maker, or whatever, stand up for Jesus! Song: *"I'll stand for Jesus and let the world go by..."*

I think we can take a lesson from the kind of people who supported David in this difficult time! There is without question a direct correlation between David's men and us with regard to what it takes to be effective and successful. Let's take a look at the requirements for being successful over the long haul: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Total commitment
- Thorough training
- Cost counting
- Supernatural strength
- Unquestioned loyalty

I. TOTAL COMMITMENT

1 Chronicles 12:8 (KJV) *"And of the Gadites there separated themselves unto David into the hold to the wilderness...."* Please remember, when these people made the decision to support David and his effort, they could never retreat! Retreat would not be tolerated; in fact, to do so would almost certainly be a signature on their death warrant! This decision was a total commitment to David and his cause!

The same thing happens to you and I; **Christ followers have no real place of retreat!** Proverbs 13:15 (KJV) *"Good understanding giveth favour: but the way of transgressors is hard."* If one is going to live a victorious life the best thing that we can do is to burn the bridges of retreat behind us!

ILLUSTRATION: When Cortez landed at Vera Cruz in 1519 to begin his conquest of Mexico, he had a small band of soldiers, which consisted of about 700

men. Once he landed it is said that he purposely set fire to his small fleet of 11 ships. His small army watched as their only means of retreat sank to the bottom of the Gulf of Mexico. With the only means of retreat destroyed, the only way to move was forward, into the Mexican interior to meet whatever might come their way!

So it is with being a soldier in the army of God! **If one is to be effective in the Christian walk a total commitment to Christ and His cause must be made in advance!** 2 Timothy 2:4 (KJV) *"No man that warreth entangleth himself with the affairs of this life; that he may please him who hath chosen him to be a soldier."* Hebrews 13:12-14 (KJV) *"Wherefore Jesus also, that he might sanctify the people with his own blood, suffered without the gate. (13) Let us go forth therefore unto him without the camp, bearing his reproach. (14) For here have we no continuing city, but we seek one to come."*

We live in perilous times, and it is sad when those who are supposed to be Soldiers in the army of God side with those who have rejected Christ as king! **It is most difficult in these times to ascertain the difference between the world and the church on many fronts:**

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Political issues...
- Character issues...
- Lifestyle issues...
- Doctrinal issues...

As you read this chapter you will soon find out that

David required men of quality, selected, separated men! Men who had made an all-out commitment to his cause and vision, men who would get the job done no matter the difficulty! Are we ready to stand up to the world and sell out to Jesus and His cause?

Are we totally committed to Christ to the point that we have already determined that nothing can separate us from Him or His cause? Romans 8:35-39 (NKJV)

“Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Shall tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword? (36) As it is written “For your sakes we are killed all the day long; we are accounted as sheep for the slaughter.” (37) Yet in all these things we are more than conquerors through Him that loved us. (38) For I am persuaded that neither death nor life, nor angels nor principalities nor powers, nor things present nor things to come, (39) nor height nor depth, nor any other created thing, shall be able to separate us from the love of God which is in Christ Jesus our Lord”

II. THOROUGH TRAINING

Notice 1 Chronicles 12:2, 8, & 38 (KJV) *“They were armed with bows and could use both the right hand and the left in hurling stones and shooting arrows out of a bow, even of Saul's brethren of Benjamin. (8) And of the Gadites there separated themselves unto David into the hold to the wilderness men of might, and men of war fit for the battle, that could handle shield and buckler, whose faces were like the faces of lions, and were as swift as roes upon the mountains; (38) All these men of war, that could*

keep rank, came with a perfect heart to Hebron, to make David king over all Israel: and all the rest also of Israel were of one heart to make David king."

The men who chose to support David were not sissies, they were lean, mean, fighting machines who had their mind made up that this was a cause worth dying for! As a result, they kept themselves in the best physical shape possible and subjected themselves to rigorous ordeal of training. The training they were subjected to was extremely demanding physically and mentally but they understood that if they desired to be the best warrior possible they would be required to go beyond the norm in the area of preparedness.

General Juan Lopez of the United States Marine Corp said, *"Training gives you a skill set to perform a specific task."*

The fighting men who served in David's military machine were expected to get up every morning prepared to fight the most intense battle of their lives. Some day's they were needed, some day's they weren't but the level of preparedness, which was required, remained the same each day.

How foolish to believe the Christian life will be easy street! If we are going to be effective soldiers we must make up our minds, this is a cause worth dying for. If this is such a worthy cause we should do everything in our power to become trained, disciplined, and properly equipped.

We have been given the whole armor of God for a reason, to fight the enemy! Ephesians 6:10-18 (KJV)
"Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord, and in the power of his might (11) Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil (12) For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places. (13) Wherefore take unto you the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand. (14) Stand therefore, having your loins girt about with truth, and having on the breastplate of righteousness; (15) And your feet shod with the preparation of the gospel of peace; (16) Above all, taking the shield of faith, wherewith ye shall be able to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked. (17) And take the helmet of salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God: (18) Praying always with all prayer and supplication in the Spirit, and watching thereunto with all perseverance and supplication for all saints;"

The armor of God is supposed to look like this in our lives: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Reproductive areas of our bodies covered with truthfulness...
- Heart and vital organs covered with doing the right thing...
- Working knowledge of God's Word to make our walk easier...
- Develop faith to the point it can be used as a

shield against every attack of the enemy...

- Cover our minds with the saving grace of God...
- Use the Word of God as an offensive weapon against the enemy...
- Develop a consistent prayer life...
- Be on the lookout for the traps of the tempter...
- Keep on keeping on...

I want to challenge each of us to use the previous list to determine the level of our training and preparedness. Do we pass or fail?

If we are going to fight this good fight of faith, we must put our armor on and make up our minds, we will fight to the finish! If we move forward with this mindset and learn to properly utilize the armor of God, we can make it! 2 Corinthians 10:3-6 (KJV) ***"For though we walk in the flesh, we do not war after the flesh: (4) For the weapons of our warfare are not carnal, but mighty through God to the pulling down of strong holds; (5) Casting down imaginations, and every high thing that exalteth itself against the knowledge of God, and bringing into captivity every thought to the obedience of Christ; (6) And having in a readiness to revenge all disobedience, when your obedience is fulfilled"***

III. COST COUNTING

The warfare David's men were engaged in could prove to be very costly, but they had predetermined this was a cause worth dying for! 1 Chronicles 12:15 (KJV) ***"These are they that went over Jordan in the first***

month, when it had overflowed all its banks: and they put to flight all them of the valleys, both toward the east, and toward the west." These were men of grit, gall, and backbone, crossing a river at flood-stage to fight a battle that could mean their life!

What kind of hardship are we willing to endure in order to win this good fight of faith? If we hope to be victorious, we must have our mind made up to persevere despite the odds.

ILLUSTRATION: When James Calvert went out as a Missionary to the cannibals of the Fiji Islands, the captain of the ship sought to turn him back. *"You will lose your life and the lives of those with you if you go among such savages,"* he said. Calvert only replied, *"We died before we came..."* God give us some more James Calvert's!

Have we... **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Counted the cost of friendships? (Abraham & his servants)
- Counted the cost of material possessions? (The disciples left their nets and followed Jesus)
- Counted the cost of worldly popularity? (Jesus said, *"If the world hated me, they will hate you."*)
- Counted the cost of surrender? (The Apostle said, *"I am not my own, I've been bought with a price."*)
- Counted the cost of submission to authority? (The Centurion said, *"I am a man UNDER*

authority.”)

The cost of selling out to Jesus in pursuit of the victorious life can be very high, but the juice is worth the squeeze! Are we willing to pay the price of victorious Christian living?

Consider the cost to the Twelve Disciples of Christ:
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Andrew died on a cross...
- Simon was crucified...
- Bartholomew was flayed alive...
- James the son of Zebedee was beheaded...
- James the son of Alphaeus was beaten to death...
- Thomas was run through with a lance...
- Mathias was stoned and then beheaded...
- Matthew was slain by the sword...
- Peter was crucified upside down...
- Thaddeus was shot to death with arrows...
- Philip was hanged...
- John was the only one of the twelve who made it through alive but he was boiled in oil and exiled to a small island in the middle of the Mediterranean Sea....

General Norman Cota made the following statement to his soldiers at Omaha Beach on June 6, 1944,

“Gentlemen, we are being killed on the beaches, let us go inland and be killed!” **(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL END OF SERVICE)**

None of us can say what the personal cost of following Christ will be, the only thing we can say for sure is that we have counted the cost and have decided to take quitting out of our vocabulary!

IV. SUPERNATURAL STRENGTH

1 Chronicles 12:8 (KJV) *"And of the Gadites there separated themselves unto David into the hold to the wilderness men of might, and men of war, fit for the battle, that could handle shield and buckler, whose faces were like the faces of lions, and were as swift as the roes upon the mountains;"(21) And they helped David against the band of the rovers: for they were all mighty men of valor, and were captains in the host."*

These men were: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

1. Men of strength... *"Men of might..."*
2. Men who were experienced fighters... *"Men of war..."*
3. Men who were battle ready... *"Fit for battle..."*
4. Men who knew how to get the most out of their weapons... *"Handle shield and buckler..."*
5. Men in whose faces only courage could be seen... *"Faces were like the faces of lions..."*

(PLACE THE SLIDE OF A LIONS FACE ON THE SCREEN)

6. Men who were sure-footed in the day of battle... *"Swift as roes (goats) upon the mountains..."*
7. Men who were full of faith rather than fear... *"Mighty men of valor...."* (A good Texas term

would be, *"I ain't skeered."*)

8. [Men whose leadership skills had been tested and proven...](#) *"Captains in the host..."*

The men who were following David looked and acted the part of mighty warriors. General Phil Sheridan said, *"Always make your opponent think you know more than you do."* The book of Hebrews says *"Cast not away therefore your confidence which has great recompense of reward."*

The men who separated themselves unto David were men whose total reliance was not upon themselves but upon the God who was empowering David. We should never forget, the Holy Spirit is constantly at work in and through the life of the believer. Our confidence is not based in the ability of the flesh but of the Spirit! This is a life of Holy Spirit empowered servitude!

[Julius Caesar](#) said, *"I came, I saw, I conquered!"* Let me remind you that none of us win the victory in and of ourselves! As much as these guys had going for them, they would never be able to accomplish everything God had purposed for them apart from the empowerment of the Spirit! We must have supernatural strength and anointing! When we walk in the anointing, 300 men with pitchers and lanterns can defeat every imp in hell, or Houston! Moses said, *"If your presence is not going to go with us, carry us not up hence."*

[Ask the following people for their response to whether](#)

they needed the empowerment of the Spirit to accomplish the purpose of God in their lifetime:

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Noah – *“The anointing will provide an ark for the floodwaters...”*
- Three Hebrew Children - *“The anointing will rob the heat from our fiery furnaces...”*
- Daniel - *“The anointing will give the lions lockjaw when we are called upon to spend a night in their den...”*
- David - *“The anointing will cause us to come back from the battle dragging a bloody giants head...”*
- Paul - *“The anointing will neutralize the venom of a deadly viper...”*
- Us - *“The anointing will cause the improbable to become probable...”*
- All of Gods Children - *“The anointing will cause the impossible to become possible...”*

Robert Kagan said, *“When you have a hammer, all problems start to look like nails. Nations without great military power face the opposite danger; when you don’t have a hammer you don’t want anything to look like nails.”*

Leviticus 26:7-9 (KJV) *“And ye shall chase your enemies, and they shall fall before you by the sword. (8) And five of you shall chase an hundred, and an hundred of you shall put ten thousand to flight: and your enemies shall fall before you by the sword. (9) For I will have respect unto you, and make you fruitful, and multiply you, and establish my covenant*

with you." Using the rational mind we would think, if
5 chases 100...
10 would chase 200...
20 would chase 400...
40 would chase 800...
50 would chase 1,000...
500 would chase 10,000...
Right? Wrong! ***"A hundred of you shall put 10,000
to flight!"*** This is what occurs when the power of the
Holy Spirit is allowed to work through comradery and
unity!

Here is a wonderful truth: I need you and you need me
but there is nothing we need more the empowerment
of the Holy Spirit!

This is not possible without two things: **(PLACE ON
THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- The anointing...
- Stick-ability...

If we will place ourselves in a position of allowing
Gods anointing in our lives and stay the course, God
will provide the strength to wage the war to its
successful conclusion!

V. UNQUESTIONED LOYALTY

1 Chronicles 12:16-18 (KJV) *"And there came of the
children of Benjamin and Judah to the hold unto
David. (17) And David went out to meet them, and
answered and said unto them, if ye become peaceably
unto me to help me, mine heart shall be knit unto
you: but if ye be come to betray me to mine enemies,*

seeing there is no wrong in mine hands, the God of our fathers look thereon, and rebuke it. (18) Then the spirit came upon Amasai, who was chief of the captains, and he said, Thine are we, David, and on thy side, thou son of Jesse: peace, peace be unto thee, and peace be to thine helpers; for thy God helpeth thee. Then David received them, and made them captains of the band,"

The setting of 1 Chronicles chapter twelve is that David and those supporting him are fleeing from Saul, as a result their living conditions lacked any kind of convenience whatsoever. In fact, they were holed up in a makeshift fort in the middle of the wilderness. (Story of convincing Susan to go with me to preach a wilderness camp in Northern Manitoba Canada)

On the surface, this setup had a Robin Hood kind of feel to it but the reality of the matter was much different. [The conditions awaiting anyone defecting to David and his cause were:](#) **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- [Low morale...](#)
- [Lack of trust...](#)
- [Primitive living conditions...](#)
- [Hiding from the government...](#)
- [Fleeing from a psychotic King...](#)
- [Being viewed as a rebel rather than a warrior...](#)

Given the conditions, it is amazing to me that anyone would defect from the Army of Saul to join with David. Many did, and among them were the eleven men from the tribe of Gad. The choice the eleven men

of Gad made was certainly not a flippant decision but a calculated risk whose upside potential proved to be astronomical.

The point is, David was right and he was God's chosen successor for Saul whom He had rejected because the spirit of rebellion had tarnished his reign.

The path of least resistance is rarely ever the will of God! This world's system attempts to pour everyone into the same mold and have each of us to go with the flow. **There comes a time for each of us to: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Swim upstream...
- Take a stand against evil decisions...
- Stand against the tide of public opinion...
- Be willing to risk life and limb for what is right...

While we must stand against evil there are two things we must always remember: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- We must make sure we are choosing to be on the side of what is right...
- We must always maintain a proper attitude while taking our stand...

You can bet these eleven men were convinced David was right and he was God's appointed and anointed leader before they came to join themselves to his cause. I think the bad attitude of Saul toward David and David's excellent spirit toward Saul may have been the thing that tipped the scales for this decision.

Before we attach our loyalty to a thing we must make sure we are siding with what is right, and then maintain a good attitude while defeating evil in this world!

Robert Benchley said, *“A boy can learn a lot from a dog; obedience, loyalty, and the importance of turning around three times before lying down.”*

At the beginning, David questioned the loyalty of these warriors. In the end however, he could sense the loyalty of these brave, courageous, determined, fearless, gutsy followers. He could sense that these were people who would have his back on the day of battle. They were people who would not cause worry lines in his forehead! [Joyce Maynard](#) said, *“A person who deserves my loyalty receives it.”* These men asked for, earned, and received, David’s trust and respect. I am a Pastor who expects the loyalty of church members and with staff it is non-negotiable. Just as I expect loyalty, I give loyalty in return. Loyalty is built on trust, when trust is eroded there is nothing to support the weight of loyalty and it collapses. When one expects and gives loyalty the result is a high-risk relationship. The deeper one loves the more disappointment hurts. However, when everyone in the relationship walks within the perimeters of loyalty, the sky is the limit for the upside of the relationship.

The ancestry of the tribe of Gad can be traced to the seventh son of Jacob. The tribe of Gad was by-in-

large sheep tenders and livestock growers. For them to morph into a rag tag group of fierce warriors was a gargantuan leap of faith and effort.

The people who had joined David previously were mostly a group of weary, distressed, discontented, broke, busted, soldiers of fortune who were in it more for what they could get than what they could add to the cause.

The eleven sons of Gad joining the cause of David was an epic event and marked a change in the kind of people who would eventually carry David to the throne and fight his enemies over the forty-year period of his reign. It is interesting to note that after receiving a war torn nation, the forty-year reign of David produced a nation in peace when Solomon came to power. The eleven sons of Gad were an important part of David's Kingdom and served with the utmost loyalty and dignity throughout David's reign.

If we are going to live a victorious life we must be people of unquestioned loyalty! The harder the battle, the more necessary the commitment to loyalty becomes! Mark 8:34 (KJV) ***"And when he had called the people unto him with his disciples also, he said unto them, Whosoever will come after me, let him deny himself, and take up his cross, and follow me."***

According to Jesus, three things are required to become one of His disciples:

- Self-denial...
- Cross-bearing...
- Follow-ship...

Edwin Louis Cole said, *“Loyalty is the virtue of faithfulness.”* **(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL END OF SERVICE)** The crown of faithfulness will be given to those who finish well. We must not lose patience in the fight and make a break with our loyalty because *“Those who endure to the end shall be saved.”*

SONG: *“I have decided to follow Jesus.” “Where He leads me I will follow.”*